

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Imaad Taimuri

Address: 127 Northey Avenue Cheam SM2 7HQ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I have been a local resident in Sutton for the best part of 20 years. Growing up there was a lack of youth activities and I felt there was not that much of a community. I got introduced to BASMA about 5 years ago and have been attending regular congregations since. BASMA brings about a sense of community in the locality and over the last 20 years this was something that was lacking. They regularly host discussions, festivals, get togethers, careers talks, and do activities which support the youth and the most vulnerable in our society. The community came together to fund the purchase of the Ambulance centre and this is largely a community led project by local residents, for the local residents. This project is to create a central location where BASMA can base themselves and continue to provide benefit to the local community. Whilst BASMA has put in permission for a place of worship, it keeps its doors open to people of all faiths and also to those that do not follow a particular faith. Should the permission be granted, the developed accommodation can host youth clubs, recreational halls and community get togethers.

With respect to the property itself, this has been a derelict ambulance centre for many years. It sold at auction a few years, and being a valuer and surveyor myself, it most likely sold at auction due to lack of demand for such a property. This suggests that this premises would have remained a derelict site for many years to come. The application submitted by BASMA makes good use of this land which would have otherwise been wasted. The NPPF and current Government agenda is to promote the development of brownfield sites and this application for the ambulance centre fits this category. The proposed plans make good majority of the existing structure and building footprint suggesting the environmental impact of the development will be minimal as opposed to keeping a derelict site in the locality. A small extension has been proposed, however this is towards the rear of the building and has been incorporated in the design to maintain a female

friendly use of the space encouraging diversity and inclusion. The planning application has taken into consideration parking provisions by incorporating 12 onsite parking provisions and 2 disabled parking spaces. The operational times have factored in school pick up timings thereby not causing unnecessary strain on local infrastructure. The biodiversity of the site has been factored in maintaining green spaces, and a cycle storage facility is also incorporated within the design. The location is such where local residents can walk to the site. This suggests that the design and location has great consideration for the environment and general wellbeing of individuals.

One similar development in the area which comes to mind is the Church at the bottom end of Northey Avenue. Regular congregations occur here and on street and off street parking is incorporated however this use of their site is welcomed by locals and has not had a severe impact on local traffic. This Church does bring together community and I am very confident that should the application for the ambulance centre be granted, a similar positive effect would take place in the area.

In conclusion, I feel the application for the ambulance centre is a proposed development which I feel will greatly benefit the local community and help promote Sutton, Belmont, and Cheam as a welcoming, diverse, and considerate neighbourhood. I therefore humbly request that this application is given the positive light that it deserves and that it is granted over an overwhelming support from the locals in the area.

Regards,
Imaad Taimuri,
BSc(Hons) AssocRICS Registered Valuer